26900209 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCENG301 - AN INTRODUCTION TO LITERARY CRITICISM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Name the neoclassical critic who challenges male dominated literary authority. [K] / [CO1]

   a). John Dryden b). Aphra Behn

   c). Alexander Pope d). Samuel Johnson

2. Which of the following is not one of Horace's concerns about poetry? [U] / [CO1]

   a). Moral and social functions of poetry | b). The role of the audience | c). Literary history | d). Rejection of literary tradition

3. Which Harvard professor led the twentieth-century critical movement known as the "New Humanists"? [K] / [CO2]

   a). Irving Babbitt | b). Arthur Quiller-Couch | c). George Saintsbury | d). William Dean Howells

4. The two opposing forces in Nietzsche's account of Greek tragedy are: [K] / [CO2]

a). Classical and modern

b).Rational and irrational

c). Apollonian and Dionysian

d). Individual and social

5. Bakhtin considers every utterance to be: [U] / [CO2]

a).Isolated from previous language

b).Free from social influences

c).Part of an ongoing dialogue

d).Completely neutral

6. If a critic argues that literary beauty arises mainly from the proper arrangement of words and poetic qualities rather than figures of speech alone, which school does this position represent? [An] / [CO3]

a). Alaṅkāra School b). Dhvani School

c). Rīti School d). Aucitya School

7. Why did Kāvyaprakāśa become extremely popular among scholars? [U] / [CO3]

a). It gathered ideas from many earlier theorists in a clear and organized manner

b). It rejected earlier theories

c). It focused exclusively on Sanskrit drama

d). It focused only on drama

8. Vyabhicāribhāvas are also known as: [K] / [CO3]

a).Sāttvikabhāvas

b).Sañcāribhāvas / temporary emotions that support the main emotion

c).Alaṅkāras

d). Gunas

9. Who coined the term' New criticism'.? [U] / [CO4]

a). I.A Richards b). T.S Eliot c). John Crowe Ransom d). Cleanth Brooks

10. Liberal humanism denies the [K] / [CO4]

a). content b). context c). literarianess d). none

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11.	Explain Emerson's idea of transcendentalism.	[U] / [CO1]
12.	Identify the major reasons for Plato’s criticism of poetry in The Republic.	[U] / [CO1]
13.	Explain Dryden’s idea that writers should not just follow “nature.”	[U] / [CO1]
14.	What central argument did Boris Eichenbaum advance regarding the relationship between poetry and ordinary everyday speech?	[U] / [CO2]
15.	How did I. A. Richards distinguish the literary use of language from everyday communication?	[U] / [CO2]
16.	List the nine Rasas (Navarasa) with their corresponding Sthāyibhāvas.	[K] / [CO3]
17.	The paradox of Alankara and Svabhavokti in Indian Poetics	[U] / [CO3]
18.	How does F. R. Leavis evaluate Jane Austen and Charles Dickens as novelists?	[A] / [CO4]
19.	Explain how tone is identified in a poetic passage through close reading.	[An] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20.	What are the major characteristics that distinguish English Romanticism from other literary periods?	[U] / [CO1]
21.	Discuss John Crowe Ransom's major principles of New Criticism and his emphasis on the close study of the literary work.	[U] / [CO2]
22.	Examine the evolution of Sanskrit literary theory from the early theorists to the later tradition.	[An] / [CO3]

23. Read the following passage and write a close reading of it. Discuss imagery, tone, theme of change, and the symbolic role of the river. [An] / [CO4]

The river had changed since his childhood. Once it roared with life, carrying boats and stories from village to village. Now it moved slowly, choked by weeds and plastic, its surface dull under the afternoon sun. Children no longer played on its banks, and the old ferryman sat idle, his oars resting like forgotten tools. The river seemed to wait for something that would never return.

[15x2 = 30]